

POL101-20 Midterm Revision

Focus: revise the course arc without guessing the exam question

Concepts, thinkers, typologies, and careful application

Concepts and Readings:

1. Heywood and Sartori: define politics and set boundaries.
2. Classical thinkers: explain community, authority, order, rights, consent, and legitimacy.
3. Kautilya / Chanakya and Machiavelli: explain statecraft, resources, strategy, and survival.
4. Weber, Krasner, and Tilly: explain modern state, sovereignty, and state capacity.
5. Hunt, Lefebvre, Gellner, and Anderson: explain economy, society, and national belonging.

Concept: What Counts as Politics?

- 1. Heywood gives the map: politics as arena and politics as process.
- 2. Arena means formal sites such as government and public affairs.
- 3. Process means compromise, consensus, conflict, and power.
- 4. Sartori gives the caution: if politics means everything, it loses analytical clarity.
- 5. Together: define politics, then locate the political site carefully.

How Heywood and Sartori Speak to Each Other

- 1. Heywood expands the meaning of politics so students see several lanes.
- 2. Sartori narrows the boundary so students do not call every social issue political.
- 3. Convergence: both help us identify politics as rule, power, and collective decision-making.
- 4. Difference: Heywood maps approaches; Sartori protects conceptual precision.
- 5. Everyday example: a family disagreement is not automatically politics; a city rule affecting all commuters is closer to politics.

Concept 2: Why Authority?

- 1. Aristotle: the polis grows from human association and aims at the good life.
- 2. Ibn Khaldun: cooperation is necessary, but society needs restraining authority.
- 3. Hobbes: insecurity creates the need for a common sovereign authority.
- 4. Locke: legitimate government protects rights and rests on consent.
- 5. Rousseau: legitimate rule comes from the people acting together through the general will.

Classical Thinkers:

1. Similarity: all ask why human beings need political order or authority.
2. Aristotle is community-centered: political life aims beyond survival.
3. Hobbes is security-centered: peace needs enforceable authority.
4. Locke and Rousseau are legitimacy-centered: authority must be justified to the people.
5. Use these thinkers to build foundations, not to replace the modern state readings.

Concept 3: Statecraft

1. Kautilya / Chanakya: The rule requires organized capacity.
2. Core elements: ruler, ministers, territory, fort or security, treasury, army, and allies.
3. Machiavelli: rule requires strategy, judgment, timing, and survival under uncertainty.
4. Similarity: both treat politics as a practical rule, not only as moral ideals.
5. Bridge to Weber: authority must become institutional, territorial, and administratively organized.

Concept 4: Weber and the Modern State

1. Modern state: a human community claiming monopoly of legitimate physical force within a territory.
2. Politics: striving for a share of power or influence over power distribution.
3. Three grounds of legitimate rule: traditional, charismatic, legal-rational.
4. Types of politicians: occasional, part-time, professional.
5. Administration matters: officials, records, money, offices, equipment, and obedience.

Weber: Further Clarification

1. Weber does not say the state uses force all the time.
2. He does not say force is the state's only tool.
3. He says legitimate force is the distinctive means of the modern state.
4. The state also depends on law, administration, legitimacy, and material resources.
5. Everyday example: traffic control or emergency road closure is official authority, not private force.

Concept 5: Sovereignty After Weber

1. Weber helps define the state inside a territory.
2. Krasner asks how sovereignty works in the wider international system.
3. Four meanings: domestic, interdependence, international legal, Westphalian / Vattelien.
4. Four compromises: convention, contract, coercion, imposition.
5. Main lesson: sovereignty is powerful as a norm, but uneven in practice.

Krasner: Meanings of Sovereignty

1. Domestic sovereignty: internal authority and effective control.
2. Interdependence sovereignty: control over cross-border flows.
3. International legal sovereignty: recognition by other states.
4. Westphalian / Vattelien sovereignty: freedom from external authority inside domestic affairs.
5. Do not assume all four are equally strong in every state.

Krasner: Ways Sovereignty Can Be Compromised

1. Convention: accepted rule or practice among states.
2. Contract: a voluntary agreement that limits some freedom of action.
3. Coercion: pressure that forces a state to accept limits.
4. Imposition: external authority imposes arrangements without meaningful choice.
5. Careful answers explain which meaning or compromise is relevant.

Concept 6: State Capacity After Sovereignty

1. Tilly asks how states historically build capacity and concentrated coercion.
2. War-making: neutralizing external rivals.
3. State-making: neutralizing internal rivals.
4. Protection: protecting clients, allies, or populations from threats.
5. Extraction: acquiring resources needed for the first three.

How Weber, Krasner, and Tilly Speak Together

1. Weber defines the modern state by its legitimate use of force and territory.
2. Krasner shows sovereignty has multiple meanings and real-world compromises.
3. Tilly explains how states gain capacity through conflict, protection, extraction, and organization.
4. Convergence: all treat the state as more than a service provider.
5. Difference: Weber defines; Krasner complicates; Tilly explains formation and capacity.

Concept 7: Hunt and Capitalism

1. Hunt does not treat capitalism as simple buying and selling.
2. Mode of production = forces of production + social relations of production.
3. Forces of production: labor, tools, machines, technology, skills, resources.
4. Social relations of production: ownership, labor, class, control, and surplus.
5. Two values: use value and exchange value.

Hunt: Four Features of Capitalism

1. Commodity production for the market.
2. Private ownership of the means of production.
3. A large population that sells labor power.
4. Acquisitive, maximizing, or profit-seeking behavior.
5. Learning point: ask who produces, who owns, who works, and who controls surplus.

Concept 8: Lefebvre and the State Apparatus

1. The state is not only one leader, one office, or service delivery.
2. State apparatus means laws, bureaucracy, planning, courts, agencies, officials, and regulation.
3. The state and economy are historically connected.
4. Economic growth and state development do not follow one universal path.
5. Social forces mediate between economy and politics.

Lefebvre: Six Thoughts to Retain

1. Economic growth and the state are historically connected.
2. Capitalism grows out of earlier social structures.
3. State and economy do not develop in the same order everywhere.
4. The bourgeoisie has different forms.
5. Economy does not directly produce politics; social groups mediate the relationship.
6. Democracy needs pressure, participation, accountability, and active society.

Hunt and Lefebvre: How do they speak to Each Other?

1. Hunt explains capitalism as production, ownership, labor, market exchange, and surplus.
2. Lefebvre explains how the state apparatus interacts with capitalism, class forces, bureaucracy, and democracy.
3. Convergence: the economy is not outside politics.
4. Difference: Hunt focuses more on economic structure; Lefebvre focuses more on state-society-economy interaction.
5. Everyday example: a delivery service needs labor, roads, regulation, payments, ownership, and public rules.

Concept 9: Nation and Nationalism

1. The state governs through institutions, territory, law, authority, and administration.
2. The nation belongs to peoplehood, memory, imagination, culture, and recognition.
3. Nationalism links belonging to political authority.
4. The nation-state is an ideal fit between state and nation, not an automatic fact.
5. Do not confuse citizenship, statehood, nationality, and nationalism.

Gellner: Nationalism as Political Principle

1. Nationalism is the principle that the political unit and the national unit should be congruent.
2. Meaning: rulers and ruled should belong to the same nation.
3. Nation: shared culture and mutual recognition.
4. Nationality: belonging to a national group.
5. Main lesson: nationalism asks for a fit between state boundaries and national belonging.

Anderson: Nation as Imagined Political Community

1. Nation = imagined political community.
2. Imagined: members do not personally know most others, yet imagine communion.
3. Limited: nations have boundaries; no nation imagines itself as all of humanity.
4. Sovereign: nationhood grows in an age when dynastic and religious authority decline.
5. Community: imagined as horizontal comradeship despite inequality.

Gellner and Anderson: Same Issue, Different Lens

1. Gellner asks why nationalism wants nation and state to match.
2. Anderson asks how people imagine themselves as one nation.
3. Gellner gives the political principle: national and political units should fit.
4. Anderson gives the cultural imagination: people feel communion with strangers.
5. Together, nationalism links identity, sovereignty, legitimacy, and state authority.

Gellner and Anderson: Concept Comparison

1. Nation: Gellner - shared culture and mutual recognition; Anderson - imagined political community.
2. Nationality: Gellner - belonging to a national group; Anderson - felt identity or nation-ness.
3. Nationalism: Gellner – a political principle that the nation and state should match.
4. Nationalism: Anderson - cultural-political attachment to the imagined nation.
5. Use both when explaining why belonging becomes politically powerful.



Everyday Example: Heavy Rain and City Commute

1. Natural event: rain itself is not politics.
2. Political site: public authority decides drainage, traffic, roads, warnings, budget, and coordination.
3. Weber: official traffic control shows legal-rational authority and legitimate public rule.
4. Tilly: protection requires resources, records, staff, equipment, and extraction.
5. Hunt and Lefebvre: transport disruption affects labor, markets, planning, state apparatus, and social forces.



Everyday Example: National Weather Bulletin

1. A national weather bulletin is technical information, but it also creates shared public awareness.
2. Anderson: People in distant places imagine the same public event at the same time.
3. Gellner: if public institutions use shared symbols, language, or curriculum, they may shape national belonging.
4. Krasner: cross-border weather, aid, or standards can also remind us that sovereignty is not always isolated.
5. Good examples explain the concept without blaming or emotional overstatement.